Silent Saturday
May 2, 2015

Information for Coaches and Spectators

"Silent Saturday" is **ONE DAY** out of the schedule in which parents, coaches and spectators are **encouraged not to talk to or call out to players on the field** during the game. This may sound like a radical idea, but the program has met with huge success in both large and small clubs throughout the United States.

The feedback that we received from our fall 2014 trial has been largely positive. Several coaches commented on how well their players communicated on the field, something that seldom gets noticed in all of the extra noise of typical game days.

Oftentimes, it is the kids themselves who express the most positive feedback. Players said they could concentrate more; some said that they liked not having their parents yell at them if they "messed up." The kids were happy that their parents made signs and banners with their names on them, or wore team t-shirts. They liked being able to make decisions (who takes the ball out, who does the goal kick, etc.). Remember - kids go out on the playground every day and play soccer, baseball and basketball without help or cheers from the sidelines.

The Objectives of Silent Saturday

- To give players a chance to trust their skills and instincts without sideline input, and without concern that their mistakes will be corrected from the sidelines in a game.
- To foster leadership skills among the individual players as they have the unique opportunity of giving (coach) instruction on the field.
- To foster a sense of true teamwork as the players must learn to rely upon one another and communicate with each other accordingly.
- To remind coaches, parents, and players that PRACTICE is the time for instruction. Games are the showcases for learning.
- To remind everyone that youth soccer is primarily for the purpose of kids playing, learning and having fun.
- To support our youth referees.

RULES

- Silent Saturday will be May 2, 2015.
- Silent Saturday applies to U8 – U14 boys and girls teams.
- To facilitate with teaching of the youngest and least experienced players/age group, **U8 Coaches** may provide instruction to players on the field, however parents are asked to observe the rules of silence.
- In all other divisions**,** coaches and parents are asked to observe the rules of silence.
- Coaches are permitted to call out for substitutions.
- Coaches may speak to their players on the sidelines, giving them instructions to carry out onto the field, such as "Joey, I want you to switch positions with Tommy", and "Make sure Sierra gets a chance to do a throw in, ok?"
- Coaches are encouraged to remind the referees prior to the game that the referees ARE allowed to speak.
- Coaches are encouraged to have their players practice "Silent Saturday" skills in the weeks leading up to the "Silent Saturday" weekend.
- Skills may include but are not limited to: appointing team captains that will direct play on the field during the game, teaching players during practice how to communicate with each other during game play, speaking to players on the sidelines before they enter the field during the game, etc.
- Parents are encouraged to make posters, signs, or banners supporting the team. Teams or individual parents can make t-shirts showing their child's name, or jersey number, or even a photo.
- Parents are asked to limit audible support to clapping only.